

State of the Web 2020–2025

HTTP Archive Trends in Page Weight, Protocols, and Security

Data source: HTTP Archive – State of the Web Report | Jan 2020 – Mar 2026

For web performance engineers and front-end architects evaluating infrastructure trends

Crawl Sample Size Tripled: From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020

Wayback Machine continuously crawls millions of URLs. The sample expanded sharply in mid-2022 and has stabilized since.



Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop

Total transfer size has risen ~25% since 2020. Mobile tracks slightly below desktop with similar growth.



76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

Request counts rose modestly (~3%), but multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 cut TCP connections by 15–27%.

Total Requests (median)

76

Desktop

71

Mobile

▲ 2.7% desktop | ▲ 2.9% mobile

TCP Connections / Page (median)

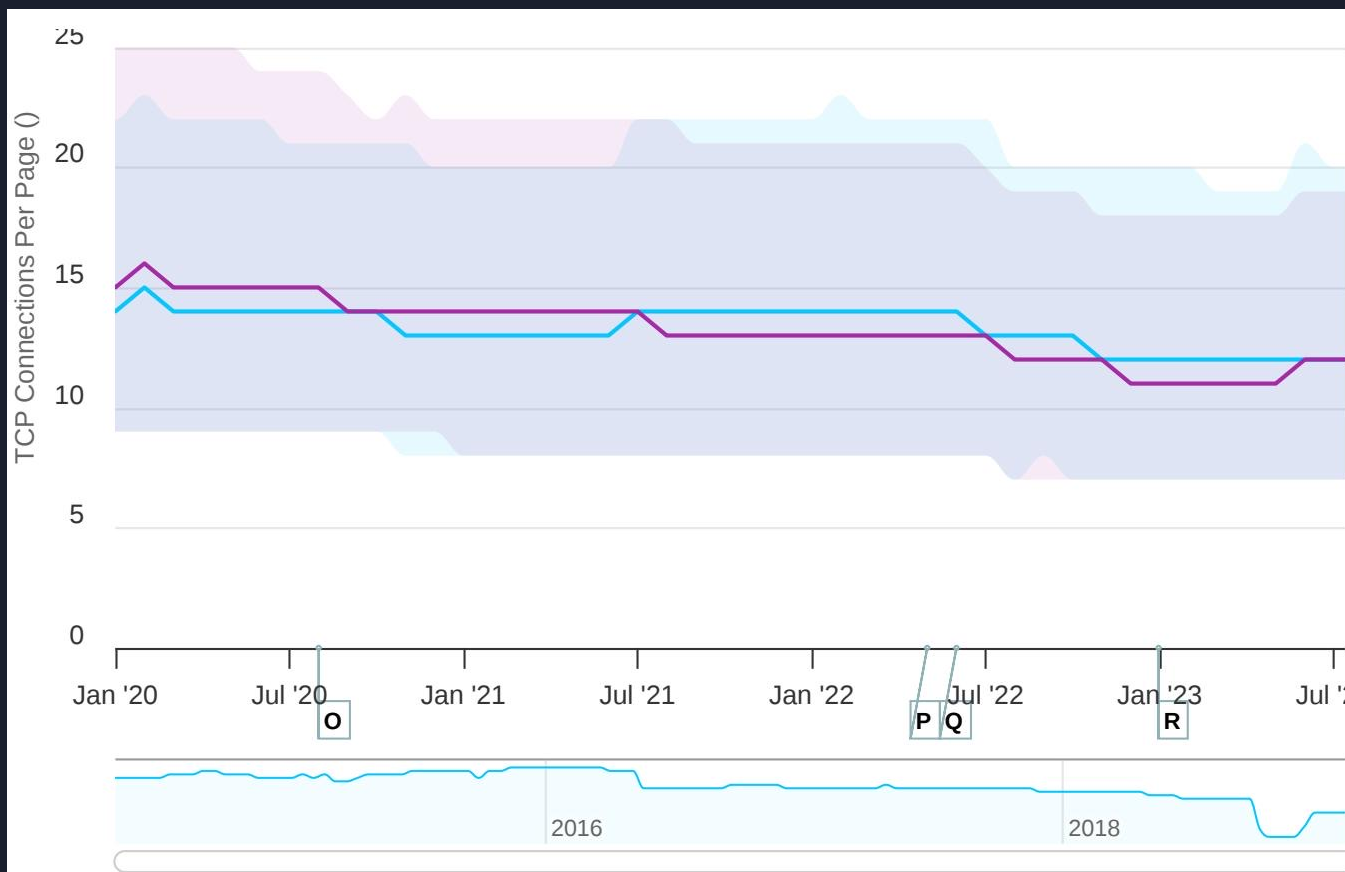
12.0

Desktop

11.0

Mobile

▼ 14.3% desktop | ▼ 26.7% mobile



TCP Connections Per Page — declining trend reflects HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 multiplexing benefits

HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

Unencrypted HTTP is effectively extinct on the modern web. Adoption climbed ~19–20 percentage points since 2020.

99.2%

Desktop requests via HTTPS

99.1%

Mobile requests via HTTPS

Up ~19–20 pp from ~80% in early 2020

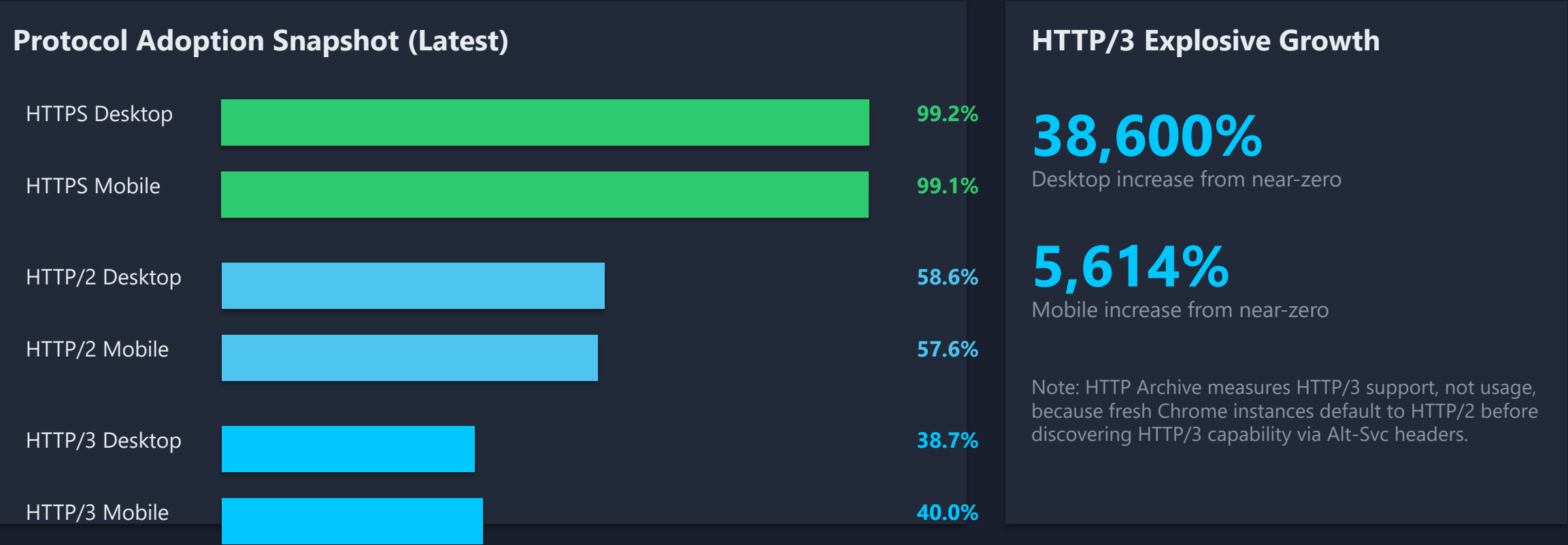
HTTPS Adoption Trajectory



Climb from ~80% to 99%+ over the observation period

HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%

HTTP/2 growth is modest as HTTP/3 absorbs newer adoption. HTTP/3 measured as support (fresh Chrome defaults to HTTP/2 first).



Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020

The font-display CSS property avoids Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT). Adoption is growing, but >50% of pages still risk FOIT.

Desktop Pages

40.1%

Up 14.9% since 2020

Mobile Pages

42.5%

Up 61.0% since 2020

Why it matters

- font-display: swap ensures text remains visible during web font loading, improving perceived performance.
- With ~40–42% adoption, the majority of pages still leave users staring at invisible text.
- Lighthouse flags missing font-display as a performance opportunity — low-hanging fruit for many sites.

Key Takeaways: Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

Five macro trends from five years of HTTP Archive crawl data — benchmark your own infrastructure against these baselines.

1. Page weight keeps climbing

Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB, roughly 25% heavier than in 2020, driven by richer media and JavaScript.

2. HTTPS is the new baseline

At 99%+ of requests, unencrypted HTTP is essentially extinct on the modern web.

3. HTTP/3 is the fastest-growing protocol metric

From near-zero to ~40% support in under four years, HTTP/3 is rapidly becoming mainstream.

4. Fewer TCP connections despite more requests

Multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 has cut median connections per page by 15–27%, improving network efficiency.

5. Font-display still underused

At ~40–42% adoption, there is significant room for improvement in avoiding invisible text during font loading.

Call to action: Audit your own sites against these baselines. Compare page weight, request counts, protocol mix, and font-display coverage to the HTTP Archive medians.